

WIND CATCHER

Find out how to read the wind! The only difference between a howling gale and a gentle breeze is how fast the air is going. Meteorologists, the people who study weather, use a device called an anemometer to measure wind speed. You can easily make one of these for yourself—and then broadcast weather reports to your family or your class at school! There are different kinds of anemometer, but lots of them have several cups to catch the wind—just like the model shown here.



As the wind catches the cups, it pushes the anemometer around.



MEASURING THE WIND

This type of anemometer, called a Robinson anemometer, has cups that go whizzing around and around when they catch the wind. At a weather station, a sensor automatically measures the speed of rotation. But with your anemometer, which is made with paper cups, you do the counting yourself.

